

TEST CODE 01218010

FORM TP

CARIBBEAN EXAMINATIONS COUNCIL
SECONDARY EDUCATION CERTIFICATE
EXAMINATION
ENGLISH A

Paper 01 – General Proficiency

90 minutes

2012

READ THE FOLLOWING INSTRUCTIONS CAREFULLY.

1. This test consists of 60 items. You will have 90 minutes to answer them.
2. In addition to this test booklet, you should have an answer sheet.
3. Each item in this test has four suggested answers, lettered (A), (B), (C), (D). Read each item you are about to answer and decide which answer is best.
4. On your answer sheet, find the number which corresponds to your item and shade the space having the same letter as the answer you have chosen. Look at the sample item below.

Sample Item

Choose the word or set of words that best completes each sentence.

Someone who is suffering from influenza needs to be isolated as the disease is _____

- (A) lasting
(B) serious
(C) contagious
(D) destructive

Sample Answer

(A) (B) (C) (D)

The best answer to this item is “contagious”, so answer space (C) has been shaded.

5. If you want to change your answer, be sure to erase it completely before you fill in your new choice.
6. When you are told to begin, turn the page and work as quickly and as carefully as you can. If you cannot answer an item, go on to the next one. You may return to that item later. Your score will be the total number of correct answers.

Items 1-5

Instructions: Each sentence in this section has either one or two words missing. Choose from the four options the word or pair of words which BEST completes the meaning of the sentence.

1. The journalists were impressed by the _____ of the statesman whose speeches had a profound _____ on all who heard them.

(A) appearance reaction
(B) presence result
(C) emotion sensation
(D) eloquence effect

2. Because she had worked all day, the maid was the task of preparing supper.

(A) deprived of
(B) relieved of
(C) barred from
(D) hindered from

3. Parents should try to their children so that they may eventually become

(A) discipline timid
(B) train intelligible
(C) pamper acceptable
(D) educate self-sufficient

4. Justice must be seen to be done, for _____ treatment can cause great _____.

(A) unfair resentment
(B) pronounced anger
(C) unlawful surprise
(D) unrewarded bitterness

5. There are many who would try to _____ your efforts because of their jealousy.

(A) assist
(B) affect
(C) thwart
(D) encourage

Items 6-10

Instructions: Choose the word or phrase that is almost OPPOSITE in meaning to the underlined word or phrase.

6. The headgear worn by the factory worker is made from artificial material.
- (A) natural
(B) synthetic
(C) man-made
(D) prefabricated
7. His character was such that he was always daunted by a challenge.
- (A) relieved
(B) satisfied
(C) surprised
(D) encouraged
8. The tourist brochure gave verbose accounts of the Carnival festivities of last year.
- (A) concise
(B) pleasing
(C) colourful
(D) accurate
9. Having thought about it, I find the idea quite repugnant.
- (A) startling
(B) attractive
(C) interesting
(D) laudable
10. The candidate was oblivious of our plans.
- (A) aware of
(B) opposed to
(C) amused by
(D) offended by

Items 11-15

Instructions: Some of the sentences in this section are unacceptable because of inappropriate grammar, idiom or vocabulary. Some sentences are acceptable as they stand. No sentence contains more than one inappropriate element.

Choose the ONE underlined part A, B or C that is inappropriate. If the sentence is acceptable as it stands, choose D.

11. He divided the sweets among Sasha and
A B
me. No error.
C D
12. Peter now have influenza and so
A
is unable to participate in the Inter School
B C
Games. No error.
D
13. The rest of the team was not in no mood to
A B
continue the game and went off the field.
C
No error
D
14. Too much students entered the competition;
A
only one of them was good enough to
B C
reach the quarterfinals. No error
D
15. The biased reporter is concerned
not so much with the truth of what he
A B
writes, as with its credibility. No error
C D

Items 16-20

Instructions: Each sentence in this section is followed by four alternative sentences. Choose the one NEAREST IN MEANING to the original sentence.

16. When Mr. Peets was transferred on promotion from South Point to Maraval, Mrs. Adams succeeded him.
- (A) Mrs. Adams worked at Maraval after Mr. Peets left on promotion.
 - (B) Mr. Peets was succeeded by Mrs. Adams when he was promoted to a post at Maraval.
 - (C) Both Mr. Peets and Mrs. Adams were transferred on promotion: Mr. Peets to Maraval and Mrs. Adams to South Point.
 - (D) In order to get promotion, Mr. Peets had to be transferred to Maraval to allow Mrs. Adams to work at South Point.
17. The result of the flooding was some financial loss to those farmers whose crops were destroyed.
- (A) The flood destroyed crops and caused some farmers to lose money.
 - (B) After the flood, all the farmers suffered financially because of the destruction of their crops.
 - (C) When the flooding was over, the financial destruction of the farmers and their crops was evident.
 - (D) The financial loss which the farmers suffered was not helped by the flood which subsequently destroyed their crops.
18. The budget speech was undoubtedly one of the briefest in years.
- (A) The budget speech was without doubt a very brief one.
 - (B) This budget speech was among the briefest we have had for a long time.
 - (C) For a long time the budget speeches have been too long.
 - (D) This year the budget speech was better than all others.
19. It took the construction firm nearly three years to complete the new highway because of the uneven terrain and inclement weather.
- (A) Because of the uneven ground and very bad weather, the firm took over three years to complete the new highway.
 - (B) The construction firm took three years to finish the new highway because of the uneven ground and very bad weather.
 - (C) The new highway was finished in just under three years because the construction firm was faced with uneven ground and regular bad weather.
 - (D) For nearly three years the construction firm encountered uneven grounds and consistently bad weather when they tried to complete the new highway.

20. The Minister said that the members of the Opposition had acted very irresponsibly because they were not in full possession of the facts and were constantly misleading the people.

(A) Not only did the Minister say that the Opposition was irresponsible but that they were also ignorant and misleading the people.

(B) The Minister was accused by irresponsible members of the Opposition of not having full knowledge of the facts and misleading the people.

(C) The Minister accused the Opposition of irresponsible action because of their lack of knowledge and their persistent misleading of the people.

(D) It was the uninformed opinion of the Opposition that caused the Minister to accuse them of acting irresponsibly and of constantly misleading the people.

Items 21-28

Instructions: Read the following poem carefully and then answer items 21-28 on the basis of what is stated or implied.

Leisure

- What is this life if, full of care,
We have no time to stand and stare?
No time to stand beneath the bough
And stare as long as sheep or cows.
5 No time to see, in broad daylight,
Streams full of stars, like skies at night.
No time to turn at Beauty's glance,
And watch her feet, how they can dance.
No time to wait till her mouth can
10 Enrich that smile her eyes began.
A poor life this if, full of care,
We have no time to stand and stare.

W. H. Davies, "Leisure".
In Ten Twentieth-Century Poets, 1957, p.35.

21. When the poet says "full of care" (line 1) he means a life full of
- (A) anger
 - (B) duties
 - (C) boredom
 - (D) happiness
22. The poet uses the idea "stare as long as sheep or cows" (line 4) because he thinks we should
- (A) relax beneath the boughs
 - (B) stop being busy and relax
 - (C) gaze at the beauty of the skies
 - (D) stand and observe our surroundings
23. The poet implies that we need leisure in our life for it to be
- (A) vital
 - (B) relaxing
 - (C) important
 - (D) meaningful
24. "Streams full of stars, like skies at night." (line 6), is an example of
- (A) rhyme
 - (B) simile
 - (C) repetition
 - (D) onomatopoeia
25. "No time to turn ... her eyes began." (lines 7-10), is an example of
- (A) pun
 - (B) simile
 - (C) personification
 - (D) onomatopoeia
26. The poet believes we will have a "poor life" (line 11) if we do not have
- (A) time to appreciate life
 - (B) things to enjoy
 - (C) money to spend
 - (D) friends to socialize with
27. According to the poet we have "No time to see, in broad daylight, Streams full of stars ..." (lines 5-6) because we
- (A) are too busy
 - (B) are too anxious
 - (C) have no respect
 - (D) have no time for imagination
28. In which of the following lines does the poet answer the question asked in lines 1 and 2?
- (A) Line 3
 - (B) Line 5
 - (C) Line 9
 - (D) Line 11

Items 29–36

Instructions: Read the following passage carefully and then answer items 29–36 on the basis of what is stated or implied.

The Sisters

- Over the years, Marta had sent many warm and friendly messages to Elana, inviting her to visit Ilora and assuring her that she'd always be welcome. But her prodigal sister never replied. From time to time, however, traders brought news that Elana's marriage to Iyako had been blessed with two sets of twins, that Iyako had succeeded his father as ruler of the Kingdom of Horses, and that their marriage was a stormy one. For a long time there was no further news until one day, a traveller told Queen Marta that Iyako had been thrown by a wild horse and had broken his back, that Elana had lost both her beauty and her mind and, after shouting night and day that the Kingdom of Wild Horses was an accursed one, she had escaped from keepers. "They searched high and low for her, but she had vanished without a trace," the traveller said, shaking his head sadly.
- 10 The Queen immediately summoned Leha and ordered her to send search parties to all of the countries bordering on the Kingdom of Wild Horses.
- "Go to the ends of the earth if you have to, but bring my sister back to Ilora. Whoever finds her will be amply rewarded," Queen Marta said to the trackers, traders and interpreters whom Leha had recruited. But after years of futile searching, the search parties returned one by one and reported that they had found no trace of Elana.
- "It's as if your sister has vanished from the face of the earth," Leha said. "I hear you," Queen Marta said "and yet I feel in my bones that she's still alive."
- Leha had led one of the search parties, and when she returned her hair was streaked with grey and age had mapped her rough-hewn face with lines as delicate as spider webs.
- 20 The first time that Leha stepped into the Audience Room to report about her travels to distant places in search of Elana, she was both surprised and pleased to see how Queen Marta had aged. When their eyes made four, the smiling Leha said to herself, "It's as if her face had beaten very gently against the years," for she could see quite clearly how time had changed what was once an ugly countenance into a beautiful one. When a shaft of sunlight touched the cloud of white hair on the Queen's head, it became luminous, and a welcoming smile lighting up her dark face lifted Leha's spirits and made her heart sing. And somehow, all the hardships she had endured travelling across parched savannahs, through densely wooded valleys, over mountains and down turbulent rivers, were forgotten.

Jan Carew, *The Sister and Manco's Stories*, Macmillan, 2003, pp. 46–47.

- | | |
|---|--|
| 29. The style of writing in this extract can BEST be described as | 30. "Their marriage was a stormy one" (lines 4–5) implies that |
| (A) factual | (A) it was unpleasant |
| (B) descriptive | (B) it was fraught with difficulty |
| (C) narrative | (C) they got married on a stormy day |
| (D) argumentative | (D) they didn't always see eye to eye |

31. The instruction "Go to the ends of the earth" (line 12) implies that they should search
- (A) the Kingdom of Wild Horses
 - (B) every accessible land
 - (C) over mountains and down rivers
 - (D) through densely wooded valleys
32. The literary device used in the phrase "as delicate as spider webs" (line 19) is a
- (A) pun
 - (B) metaphor
 - (C) simile
 - (D) hyperbole
33. The writer implies that Leha was
- (A) a traveller
 - (B) Marta's sister
 - (C) a household servant
 - (D) the leader of the queen's army
34. Which of the following is an example of contrast?
- (A) She "had lost both her beauty and her mind" (lines 6-7).
 - (B) "she had vanished without a trace" (line 8).
 - (C) "her hair was streaked with grey" (line 18).
 - (D) "lighting up her dark face" (line 25).
35. "The cloud of white hair" (line 24) is an example of
- (A) litotes
 - (B) metaphor
 - (C) oxymoron
 - (D) personification
36. The concluding sentence of the extract
- (A) suggests they had forgotten all about Elana
 - (B) indicates that they had given up the search
 - (C) conveys the idea that the problems that Leha had encountered in the search were forgotten
 - (D) means that Leha would be willing to continue the search

Items 37-44

Instructions: Read the following extract carefully and then answer items 37-44 on the basis of what is stated or implied.

5 When the traditional family unit is discussed, it is usually in terms of the external social changes that are threatening its existence as an institution. Little thought is given to the internal problems of normal homes. The central problem for most family members is, of course, how to get along with each other. This internal matter is not without its external implications; for only where there are orderly and peaceful families can there be an orderly and peaceful society.

10 Of all the social changes that have affected the family in recent years, by far the most significant has been the increase in the number of mothers of school-age children who have taken outside employment. In Canada, some 75 per cent of women in this category now have full-time or part-time jobs. For the most part, economic imperatives have left women no choice but to work for money. An income sufficient to maintain an average family style took one Canadian 48 hours a week to earn in the 1950s. It takes two people 65 to 75 hours a week to earn that today.

15 The conflicts between work and family life and scarcity of time to devote to children have taken a personal toll on women in the form of stress and depression. Obviously, individuals under stress are harder to deal with than those who are not, so the tensions of work are carried over into tensions in mother-child relationships. Men, too, report feeling "stressed out" and squeezed between work and family obligations. Males raised in the tradition of mothers doing everything in the home are inclined to be lax in doing housework and awkward in the unaccustomed role of actively nurturing children. But if a two-income family is to run smoothly and fairly, the household workload must be shared.

20 Another profound change in family relationships lies in the relatively high incidence of divorce and marital separations in western society. The fact that so many couples feel they must go their separate ways illustrates just how difficult it is for people to live together satisfactorily at the best of times.

37. According to paragraph one (lines 1-5), which of the following results from conflict between family members?
- (A) Disorder in societies
 - (B) Anxious parents and children
 - (C) Disruptive behaviour in homes
 - (D) High levels of tension between parents
38. According to the extract, all of the following threaten the existence of the family EXCEPT
- (A) the high divorce rate in western society
 - (B) problems family members experience in getting along
 - (C) conflicts between employers and working parents
 - (D) the increase in the number of mothers of school age children working outside of the home
39. The word that is closest in meaning to "imperatives" (line 9) is
- (A) concerns
 - (B) matters
 - (C) demands
 - (D) guidelines
40. In paragraph two (lines 6-11) the writer compares income in the 1950s to income today to show that
- (A) a single income cannot adequately support an average family
 - (B) people earned more in the 1950s than today
 - (C) people today do not work as hard as people in the 1950s
 - (D) people today work longer hours for the same pay as in the 1950s
41. According to the writer in paragraph 3 (lines 12-19), tensions in mother-child relationships can occur because
- I. mothers are under stress
 - II. parents and children are under stress
 - III. mothers are depressed and hard to deal with
- (A) I only
 - (B) II only
 - (C) I and III only
 - (D) II and III only
42. The writer's main purpose is to
- (A) focus on the problems experienced by men
 - (B) reveal the problems experienced by men, women and children
 - (C) highlight some of the internal problems threatening the existence of the family
 - (D) show that single income families function better than two-income families
43. The writer's main intention in lines 15-19 is to show that
- (A) men in two-income households never help in the home
 - (B) two-income households always experience stress
 - (C) children in two-income households are neglected
 - (D) sharing of the household workload can help a two-income family to run smoothly
44. The tone of the passage may be best described as
- (A) mocking
 - (B) indignant
 - (C) complaining
 - (D) analytical

Items 45-54

Instructions: Read the following extract carefully and then answer items 45-54 on the basis of what is stated or implied.

The Press must be, in any democratic society, a dedicated Opposition.

Any Government - to a good Press - is a suspect instrument. Any Opposition, to a good Press, is opposing ineptly.

5 The good Press represents nobody but itself. It is the last stronghold of totally aristocratic privilege. It speaks for the people because it depends on the people who buy it because they like it; and because it has an unwritten contract between it and the people, who would otherwise know about the Government of the day only what the Government wanted the people to know. But this allegiance to, and contract with, the people do not bind the Press to any commitment except telling the truth. The Press elects itself, and can be removed from office only by a legitimate revolution of the people
10 that stop buying it, or by an illegitimate coup mounted by the elected estates of the Government.

Every Government is, potentially, a ravager; every people, potentially, a victim. Every good Press is an individualistic, opinionated knight who simply declares that between ravager and victim there is a force which will not be frightened by the ravager, and which will not be influenced by those to whom it sells its opinions.

15 A good Press speaks for the people who vote a Government out of power ... But the day after such a Government takes power, the Press must be ready to rebuke the people for shouting "Hurrah!" for a patently incompetent Government.

A good Press, in short, is the product of 500 years of technological development between Caxton and Baird and we make history as well as record it ... The politician never knows when one
20 editorial, one story, one commentary, one pictorial feature might not destroy him or create him.

There is nothing that the politician can do about us in the free Press ... We do not seek office, influence or advantage from the Party in power. We simply reserve the right to be a part of the governing process, with or without the approval of the elected Government or its elected Opposition. Our constituency does not depend on those who say, "I agree or I disagree" with what you had
25 to say, but on those who say "I read you! I listened to you! I saw you last night on TV!"

(Source unknown)

45. The function of the second and third sentences (lines 2-3) in the extract is to

- (A) give specific examples of "a dedicated Opposition" (line 1)
- (B) explain the statement made in the first sentence
- (C) show that the Press is only good when it acts as an opposition

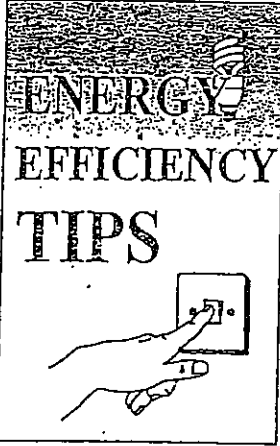
46. Why does the writer repeat the phrase "good Press" at the beginning of paragraphs three, five and six (lines 4, 15, 18)?

- (A) To emphasize the ideal characteristics of the "good Press"
- (B) To indicate contempt for the Press which is not an opposition
- (C) To stimulate greater identification

47. According to the writer, the MOST important function of the good Press is to
- (A) present the truth
 - (B) oppose the Government
 - (C) represent the views of the people
 - (D) increase the number of its subscribers
48. According to the writer, a legitimate revolution against the Press occurs by
- (A) the government closing it down
 - (B) the Press being denied its freedom
 - (C) someone establishing a rival press
 - (D) people refusing to purchase its product
49. By describing the good Press as "an individualistic, opinionated knight" (line 12) the writer is emphasising
- (A) strength
 - (B) wisdom
 - (C) honesty
 - (D) independence
50. The writer states that the good Press "... depends on the people who buy it because they like it" (line 5) and that it "... will not be influenced by those to whom it sells its opinions" (lines 13-14). These two statements taken together
- (A) argue that the Press creates popular opinions
 - (B) repeat that the good Press owes its allegiance only to its subscribers
 - (C) appear contradictory but support the argument that a good Press should be independent
 - (D) show that the power of the Press depends upon the number of its subscribers
51. According to the writer, the good Press should regard Government with
- (A) fear
 - (B) mistrust
 - (C) resentment
 - (D) disrespect
52. In paragraph 5 (lines 15-17) the writer implies that a good Press
- (A) may be deceptive
 - (B) is sometimes inconsistent
 - (C) should be open-minded
 - (D) cannot always be reliable
53. The examples of the possible effects of the press on the politician are given to
- (A) drive fear into the politicians
 - (B) show how the Press records history
 - (C) illustrate how powerful the Press really is
 - (D) demonstrate how uncertain the career of a politician is
54. Which of the following BEST describes the manner in which the writer presents his views in this extract?
- (A) Forceful
 - (B) Objective
 - (C) Detached
 - (D) Emotional

Items 55-60

Instructions: Read the following advertisement carefully and then answer items 55-60 on the basis of what is stated or implied.



**ENERGY
EFFICIENCY
TIPS**

1. Keep fixtures and bulbs clean. Dirt can absorb as much as 50% of light.
2. Turn off the lights when leaving the room even if it's only for a few minutes. It's just a myth that it takes more energy to turn a light on than to leave it on.
3. Use motion sensors for outdoor lights. They're a good security measure that doesn't waste energy.
4. Use lower wattage bulbs; your lights may be brighter than you need.
5. Purchase lamps with dimmer switches, as you can lower the settings when less light is required.
6. Place floor or table lamps in a corner. This allows light to reflect from the walls, making the room brighter without turning on more lights.
7. Use fluorescent lights instead of incandescent lights. Compact fluorescent lights use up to 75% less energy than incandescent lights, for the same amount of light and last up to ten times longer.

55. The main purpose of this advertisement is to
- (A) sell light bulbs
(B) promote lighting in the home
(C) encourage better energy use
(D) highlight energy use in the home
56. Which of the following is the meaning of the word "absorb" as used in Tip 1 of the advertisement?
- (A) Waste
(B) Store
(C) Contain
(D) Swallow
57. How much energy do fluorescent lights use?
- (A) The same amount of light as other lights
(B) Fifty per cent of what incandescent lights use
(C) Seventy-five per cent more than other lights
(D) Seventy-five per cent less than incandescent lights
58. The advertisement emphasizes that motion sensors are important because
- (A) they are cheap
(B) they waste energy indoors
(C) they do not conserve energy
(D) they are efficient and provide security
59. Which of the following is NOT stated in the advertisement?
- (A) Low wattage uses less energy.
(B) Lamps placed on the floor are better for energy efficiency.
(C) Not all light bulbs are energy efficient.
(D) Compact fluorescent lights are energy efficient.
60. The information in the advertisement would be MOST useful to
- (A) electricians
(B) contractors
(C) housewives
(D) the light company

END OF TEST